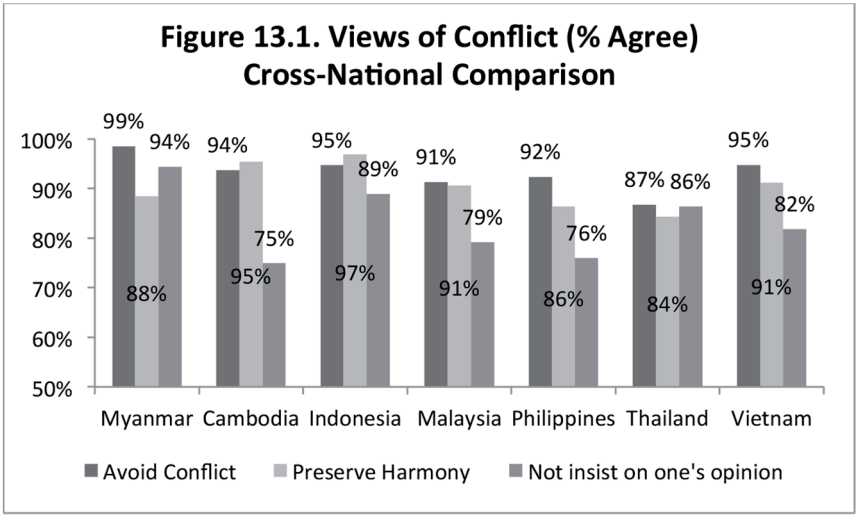
level which exceeds findings in other countries in the region.



Part of the reason for this involves recognition of the importance of conflict in society. Seventy-one per cent of Myanmar citizens in the ABS view ethnic conflict as "serious". This recognition extends across divisions, as both ethnic minorities and the Bamar majority hold this view; eighty-three per cent and sixty-seven per cent respectively. Given that most of the ethnic conflicts are concentrated in ethnic minority areas, it is understandable that a larger percentage of the ethnic minority population would see this conflict as serious.

A large percentage of the Myanmar public also sees sharp differences among rich and poor, with citizens split on the government's treatment of communities of different economic backgrounds. Some fifty-one per cent of respondents believe the government treats all groups unfairly. Myanmar citizens are more divided than people in other parts of the region, but what is striking is that a majority of Myanmar citizens see their society as divided along class lines.

ETHNICITY: DIFFERENCE WITH COMMON GROUND

The most prominent division in Myanmar has been ethnicity. Key themes in the literature on ethnic division have involved systemic discrimination on the part of the Bamar majority government towards ethnic minorities,